

HUM 2101: Sociology and Disaster Management

Introduction to Basic Concept of Government and Politics

Lecture 1.2

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Republic

- ✓ Country where the head of government is an elected or chosen president
- ✓ Sometimes the president is also the head of state
- ✓ Presidents are usually elected for a specific length of time, called a “term of office”.
- ✓ In some countries, a president may only serve for a few terms
- ✓ A republic may or may not be democratic.

Republic - form of government in which power is explicitly vested in the people, who in turn exercise their power through elected representatives.



- ✓ In a democratic republic, the people choose their leaders elections, although in countries where a president is in ceremonial role, it may be by government appointment rather than by election.
- ✓ There may be elections, but these may be conducted in corrupt ways, or electors are not given a free choice of who to vote for.

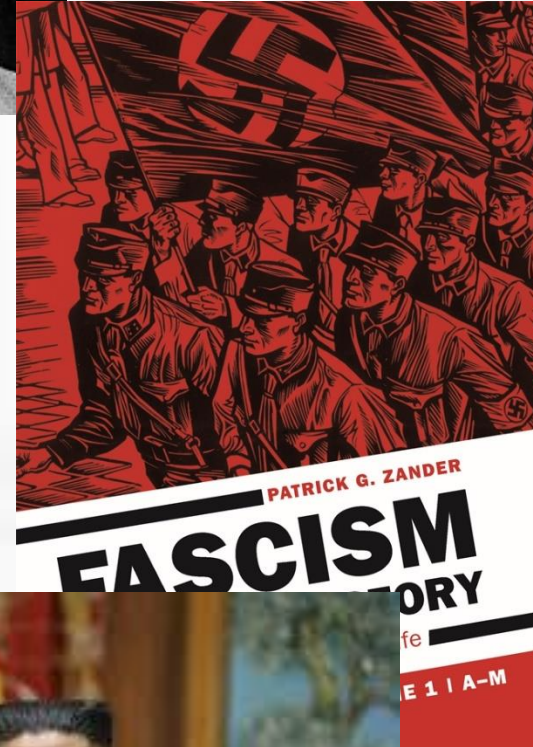
Totalitarianism

- ✓ In a totalitarian society, the government holds absolute control over all areas of the life of its people.
- ✓ A set of beliefs is imposed on its people, who must conform or face unpleasant consequences.



Fascism

- ✓ A form of government usually headed by a dictator
- ✓ Involves total government control of political, economic, cultural, religious, and social activities.



Dictatorship

- ✓ Open person, called a Dictator, has absolute power
- ✓ This differs from totalitarianism in that it is less controlling and not marked by a rigid set of beliefs
- ✓ Sometimes a country run by a dictatorship maybe called a republic. Such republics have only one political party and the dictator makes most government policies and decisions.



Communism

- ✓ An economic system in which there is little or no private ownership of anything
- ✓ Property is held by the community rather than by individuals
- ✓ All economic activity is controlled by the government, including what food crops are grown, what goods are manufactured, and to whom they are sold and at what prices.
- ✓ Limited personal freedom of individuals is allowed, including where they can travel and how they spend their money.



Socialism

- ✓ A system that encourages cooperation rather than competition among citizens.
- ✓ Citizens communally own the means of production and distribution of goods and services, while a centralized government manages it.



Capitalism

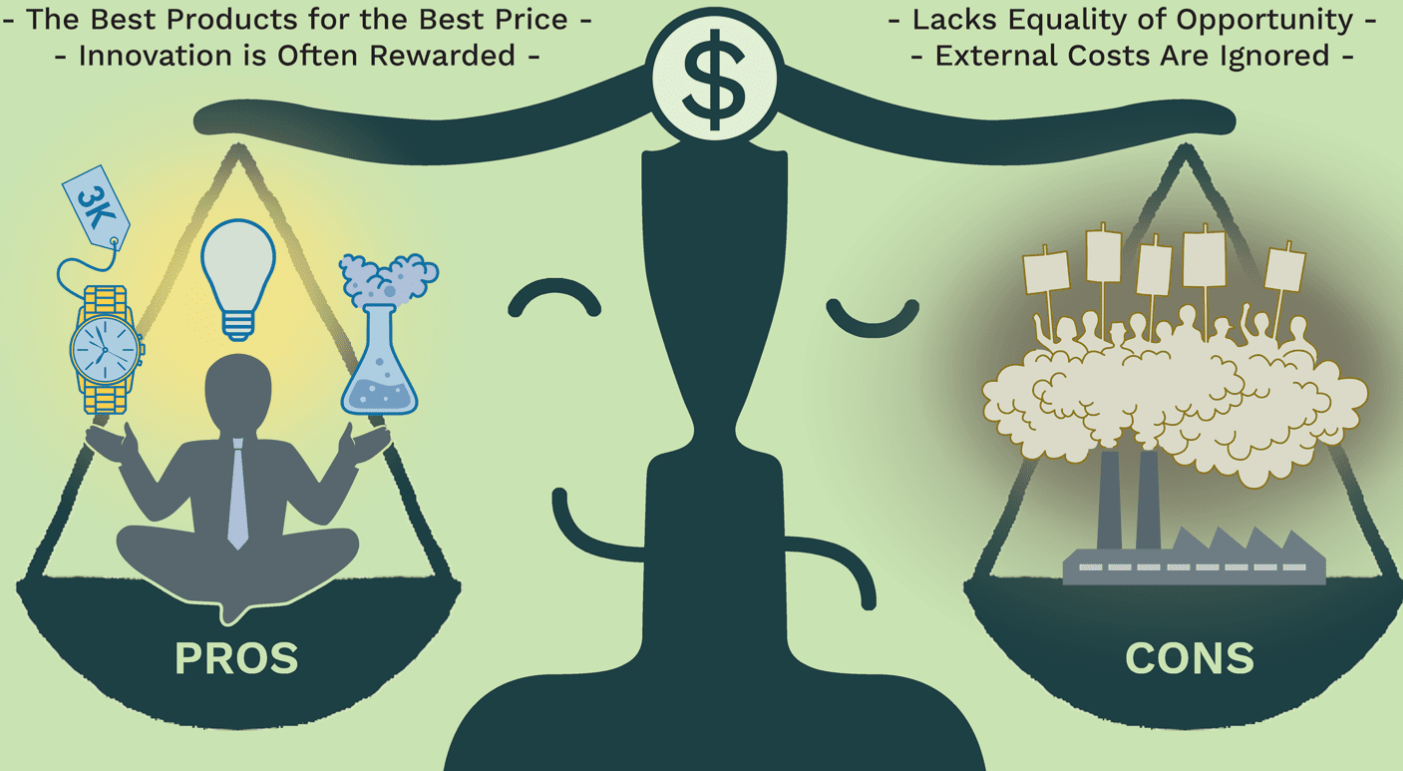
- Capitalism is an economic system in which private individuals or businesses own capital goods.
- Capitalism is often thought of as an economic system in which private actors own and control property in accord with their interests, and demand and supply freely set prices in markets in a way that can serve the best interests of society.
- The essential feature of capitalism is the motive to make a profit.



The Pros and Cons of Capitalism

- The Best Products for the Best Price -
- Innovation is Often Rewarded -

- Lacks Equality of Opportunity -
- External Costs Are Ignored -



Citizenship

- Citizenship is the expression of a public identity.
- It is the recognition of an official position by a government and the ability to enjoy the rights and privileges following from that position by an individual.
- Citizenship is also the subjective belonging to the public identity of a country.
- It involves claiming, exercising, and contesting rights, entitlements, and obligations.



Feudalism

- Derived from the Latin word: Feodum or Feudum (fief) [used during the Medieval period]
- Feudalism is a form of socio-economic and political organization with three distinct social classes:
 1. King or queen
 2. Nobles, which includes princes and priests
 3. Peasants

In a feudal society, status is based on land ownership

- ✓ The **King** owned all the available land, and he portioned out that to his nobles for their use
- ✓ The **Nobles** rented out their land to peasants
- ✓ The **Peasants** paid the nobles in produce and military service; the nobles, in turn paid the king



Political importance of feudalism

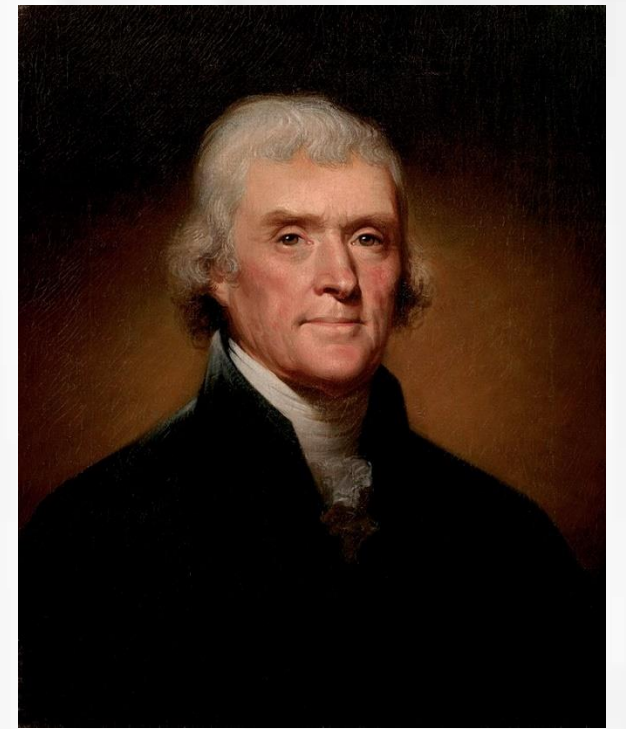
- It was conceived of as a formal political system by the people who lived during the Middle Ages

English feudalism

- English feudalism is thought to have arisen in the 11th century CE under the William the Conqueror.
- When he had the common law altered after the Norman Conquest in 1066.
- William took possession of all of England.
- Then parceled it out among his leading supporters as tenancies, or fiefs, to be held in return for services to the king



- Feudalism famously developed in Europe during the Middle Ages
- It has been identified in many other societies and time including the imperial governments of Rome, Japan, and the United States of America.
- American founding Father Thomas Jefferson
- It was convinced that the new United States was practicing a form of feudalism in the 18th Century



Feudalism arises in places where there is **an absence of organized government** and the **presence of violence**.

- A contractual relationship is formed between ruler and ruled:
 - ✓ Ruler provides access to the required land
 - ✓ The rest of the people provide support to the ruler

In England

- ✓ Feudalism was formalized into a legal system
- ✓ It was written into the laws of the country and codifying a tripartite relationship between political allegiance, military service, and property ownership

